

the simplicity of design. The PC-UM10 is an ultra-light notebook weighing less than 1.3 kg, and so is the lightweight Muramasu. With a thickness of about 16 mm, there is almost no competition to this notebook. Couple this with the fact that it features a really cool magnesium clamshell casing and a brilliant keyboard. Then add to the fact that Sharp makes some excellent build quality screens. Put all these points together and this notebook becomes a statement by itself.

The ACi Xtreme—though the name doesn't tell you that—is built like a rock. It is big and robust with a matching colour combination and weighs all of 3.6 kg. It actually makes a desktop look skinny!

The bottom line

When it comes to performance in a complete package, the Compaq Presario 1725 is the thing. Configured like a desktop and built like a portable, it lives up to all the expectations that you would have from a neat little notebook. The only gripe we had was that it lacked a decent graphics card, but then that's a minor gripe. Worthy mentions here are no doubt the ACi Xtreme and the Sharp AR-50. The ACi Xtreme loses out because of its relative lack of finesse and rather bulky design.



If you want a laptop without spending too much, then the Zenith 21A is your best bet. It wins the Digit Best Value award hands down for very simple reasons: a decent looking laptop for Rs 75,000 that bundles almost every possible external peripheral that you would desire. The Zenith 21A really takes the cake by bundling a set-top TV tuner module with a remote and cigarette lighter battery charger!

The Winners!

Compaq Presario 1722

This is a slickly designed machines with a vibrant colour combination of silver and dark blue. Configured with a P-III-M 1GHz processor, 128 MB RAM and a 14.1-inch

XGA Active Matrix Display (as well as an ATI Mobility Radeon 8MB DDR graphics card), this is one of the fastest notebooks. Highlighted here are the JBL Pro speakers that reproduce crystal clear sound with crisp notes and deep, bassy lows. Storage is taken care of by a 30 GB hard disk as well as an 8x DVD swappable with floppy drive. The Presario also has a plethora of bundled applications including Norton AntiVirus 2002, MS Money 2001 Standard, Pinnacle Studio version 7SE, as well as 30 hours of bundled Internet account from Satyam.



The New iBook

Radical designs and innovation. That's what everybody expects from Apple. Last year Apple came out with the PowerBook G4—its inventiveness ranging from the simple magnetic hinge holding the screen in place to the one-touch battery status indicator and the glowing light behind the screen. Now, when you look at the iBook, it automatically becomes clear how far the designers have come from the G4. The clear white shell looks nothing less than stunning, the finishing inside is appeal redefined, and the design reiterates Apple's position as the industry leader in design. Even though the iBook is slightly bulkier and slower than the G4, it is still way ahead of any other laptop(s) we received in this test. The 1024x768 TFT display is bright and responsive (like the G4), there's a G3 600

MHz processor inside which is twice as powerful as the last iBook, you have all connectors you would ever require, and it runs 5 hours on a full charge. The high-end series comes with a DVD CD-RW combo drive, 256 MB of RAM, built-in wireless antenna, and...well, so much more that you'll have to see it all yourself. Not to forget that it comes pre-loaded with OS X 10.1. The iBook. Intelligently beautiful.



iBook vs PowerBook G4		
Specs	iBook	PowerBook G4
CPU	G3 600 MHz	G4 550 MHz
RAM	256 MB	256 MB
Graphics	ATI Rage Mobility 8 MB	ATI Radeon Mobility 16 MB
HDD	30 GB	30 GB
Optical	CD-RW DVD Combo	Slot Loading DVD
Screen	12.1-inch Active Matrix TFT, 1024x768	15.2-inch Active Matrix TFT, 1152x768

In the tests, the Presario displayed fairly good results in both office productivity and gaming. In Content Creation 2001, it generated an index of 34.9 and 36.7 in Business Winstone 2001. In short, this is a machine which works excellently both as a desktop replacement as well as a notebook.

Rating: A-
Verdict: The Compaq 1722 oozes class in build quality and performance.

ACi Xtreme

This notebook features an amazing dual battery pack bundle that theoretically gives users 10 hours of battery power